TEACHER GUIDE

OCR A Level Business (H431)

Leadership and management

Human resources
Management and leadership: Leadership



A revision lesson. Pupils run a car dealership in firms of four and revise leadership and management on their own deals. Seat each firm together. Each firm answers the topic tasks together.

The lesson

45-minute setting

Setup	Round 1	Round 2	Round 3	Final questions

EVERY ROUND

Firm decisions
3 min

→

Deals
4½–5 min

→

Topic tasks
4 min

→

B2B deal
2½ min
from Round 2

LESSON SETTINGS

30 min	45 min	60 min	75 min

What pupils do

Every pupil buys and sells cars. In Firm decisions, each role has its own job.



CEO

Staff · Sabotage from Round 2



Finance

Capital & Loans · Investments



Sales & Marketing

Marketing



Operations

Seasonal stock

Topic tasks

Each firm gets its own figures. The method is the same. Your Live screen shows each task and every firm's answer.

1 Blake-Mouton: why

Round 1

Targets are always met, but morale is low and staff quit. The manager cares only about targets.

Using Blake-Mouton, what best explains this?

- **A** High concern for sales, low for people
- **B** Low concern for both
- **C** High concern for people, low for sales
- **D** Medium concern for both

ANSWER

✓ High concern for sales, low for people

Why: High concern for production and low for people is authority-compliance (9,1).

2 Autocratic effects

Round 1

A manager decides everything alone and gives orders.

Which two effects are most likely over time?

- **A** Fast decisions in a crisis
- **B** Staff feel more involved
- **C** Skilled staff feel undervalued
- **D** Decisions take longer
- **E** Staff gain more responsibility

ANSWER

✓ Fast decisions in a crisis
✓ Skilled staff feel undervalued

Why: Deciding alone is quick, but skilled staff want a say.

3 Continuum in order

Round 2

Four points on the Tannenbaum-Schmidt continuum.

Order them, boss-centred first?

- **A** Consults: asks, then decides
- **B** Tells: decides and announces
- **C** Delegates: the team decides
- **D** Sells: decides, then persuades

ANSWER

1. **Tells: decides and announces**
2. **Sells: decides, then persuades**
3. **Consults: asks, then decides**
4. **Delegates: the team decides**

Why: Along the continuum the manager uses less authority and staff gain freedom.

Topic tasks

4 Error rate rise

Round 2

A new laissez-faire manager took over.

Rise in the error rate, as a %?

Deals a month	**200 deals**
Pricing errors before	**16 errors**
Pricing errors now	**24 errors**

ANSWER

50%

(24 − 16) ÷ 16 × 100 = 50%

Why: Little direction suits skilled staff; here errors rose by 50%.

5 New team, deadline

Round 3

A new, untrained team must deliver a big fleet order by Friday.

Which approach fits, and why?

A Let the team decide how

B Clear instructions from the manager

ANSWER

✔ Clear instructions from the manager

Why: Untrained staff and little time need clear direction.

6 Style and the fix

Round 3

Sales fall and staff leave. The manager neither sets targets nor talks to staff.

Which style is this, and which should it move to?

A Country club → authority-compliance

B Middle of the road → team management

C Impoverished → country club

D Impoverished → team management

ANSWER

✔ Impoverished → team management

Why: Low concern for both is impoverished; Blake and Mouton see team management as best.

Final questions

Each pupil answers 6 final questions on leadership and management. They come from these 8 questions.

Then each pupil writes one short answer: “Evaluate laissez-faire leadership for your sales team.”

1. A dealer says managers welcome challenge, but staff say every failed decision is punished. Which cultural effect is most likely?
   ✔ **Staff stop raising risks or new ideas**

2. A safety incident at a branch needs immediate coordinated action. Why might a usually participative leader become more directive for now?
   ✔ **Urgent risk needs fast, clear decisions**

3. A workshop foreman decides every job allocation himself and tells technicians exactly how to do each task. Which leadership style is this?
   ✔ **Autocratic**

4. Before changing opening hours, a sales manager asks the team for views and lets them vote. Which leadership style is this?
   ✔ **Democratic**

5. Experienced technicians set their own hours and methods; the manager steps in only when asked. Which leadership style is this?
   ✔ **Laissez-faire**

6. A brake fault is found on cars in the showroom. Why might an autocratic style suit the next hour?
   ✔ **Fast, clear instructions are needed**

7. An owner decides everything herself but explains each decision and looks after staff welfare. Which leadership style is this?
   ✔ **Paternalistic**

8. What is a main drawback of democratic leadership in a busy dealership?
   ✔ **Decisions can take longer**